

Auto Clock Out Plan (Final Policy)

Policy Lock:

- For every employee, max continuous session is 12 hours from clock_in.
- If employee clocks out manually before 12 hours, keep existing normal flow.
- If employee forgets clock_out, system auto-clocks-out exactly at clock_in + 12h.
- After auto clock out, next clock-in should start a new session normally.

Implementation Workflow (According to current codebase):

1) Attendance API (app/api/attendance/route.ts)

- Add helper to close stale open record at 12h threshold.
- Trigger helper before handling new clock_in requests.
- Keep existing lock + duplicate guard unchanged.

2) Auto close details

- Find latest open session where clock_out IS NULL for employee.
- Compute auto_cutoff = clock_in + INTERVAL 12 HOUR.
- If now >= auto_cutoff, update:
 - clock_out = auto_cutoff
 - total_hours = 12.00
 - clock_out_source = auto_12h (recommended metadata)

3) Manual flow compatibility

- If employee clocks out before 12h, use existing POST clock_out flow.
- No behavior change for normal shift completion.

4) Attendance Summary UI (app/attendance-summary/page.tsx)

- Continue showing clock_out if present.
- Add Auto badge when clock_out_source == auto_12h.
- Running status only for truly open (not auto-closed) sessions.

5) Historical backfill (one-time)

- For old open records, set clock_out = clock_in + 12h.
- Set total_hours = 12.00 and optional source metadata.
- Run as preview SELECT first, then safe UPDATE.

6) Validation checklist

- 13h later new clock_in: old session auto-closes, new session opens.
- Before 12h new clock_in attempt: blocked as already clocked in.
- Summary shows clock_out time and Auto badge for auto-closed rows.

Requested Improvements Included:

- Shift-end+3h rule removed; hard overall 12h rule applied.
- Existing normal/manual behavior preserved.
- Continuous unattended 12h sessions are automatically closed.